WEATHERHEAD SCHOOL OF MANAGEMENT · CASE WESTERN RESERVE UNIVERSITY

Leadership Avatar Brand Guidelines

How the student app looks, reads, and behaves. Skim the visuals; open "More" when you need the detail.

Version 1.1 · Oct 30, 2026 · Student app · Light theme · 1440×900 first

01

Five rules

Every screen decision traces back to one of these.

CWRU Blue leads

It is on every screen, through the sidebar and titles.

Color means something

Data, status, or the one primary action. Never decoration.

Show less, reveal more

Short text up front. Long text expands or opens in a panel.

One shell, one scale

Practice, Reports, and Paths share frame, type, and spacing.

Accessible by default

4.5:1 text contrast, full keyboard use, explicit camera consent.

Why these rules

Leadership Avatar grew as several features built in parallel: an interview picker, case play, conversations, reports, study plans, and paths. Each picked its own colors and type, so students moved between what felt like three products. These rules exist so a new screen looks like it was always part of the app.

The audience is a Weatherhead student at a desk or a lab kiosk, often right before or after a high-stakes rehearsal. They need to know what to do next in a glance. That is why the guide favors fewer words on screen, one primary action per view, and color reserved for meaning.

Where this guide and the CWRU brand standards disagree, CWRU standards win. Where this guide is silent, follow `PRODUCT.md` and the existing HeroUI component defaults, restyled with the tokens below.

02

Color

The official CWRU palette, each color with one job.

BRAND BLUES

CWRU Blue
#003071 · PMS 2146 C
Sidebar, primary button, titles

Dark Blue
#09143A
Body text, video stage

True Blue
#007AB8
Links, focus, progress

Force Blue
#2359EF
Live signals only

Light Blue
#A6D2E6
Selection, tracks, level 3

NEUTRALS

White
#FFFFFF
Surfaces, cards

Canvas
#F5F8FB
Page background

Light Gray
#D3D3D3
Dividers, empty steps

Dark Gray
#999999
Disabled only

LEVELS AND STATUS · TERTIARY, 5% MAX

Vivid Green
#61A530
Level 5 · Excellent

Blue Green
#377E72
Level 4 · Strong, done

Orange
#FF9239
Level 2 · Developing

Copper Red
#D63D1F
Level 1 · Needs work, errors

Violet Purple
#692C95
AI-generated label



Start practice

DO One CWRU Blue primary action per view.

Start Review Plan

DON'T Use tertiary colors for buttons or chrome.

Due Friday · 3 drills left

DON'T Set text in Dark Gray or Light Blue. It fails contrast.

Usage rules

- **CWRU Blue is always present.** The guidelines forbid secondary or tertiary colors without CWRU Blue on the same view. The persistent sidebar satisfies this; full-screen views (session, kiosk) carry it in the top bar.
- **Reach 45% through structure, not floods.** Sidebar, page titles, primary buttons, and score numerals carry the blue. Do not paint large content areas blue.
- **True Blue is the interactive color.** Links, focus rings, active tabs, selected borders, and progress fills. Nothing else.
- **Force Blue means "happening now."** Avatar speaking, recording, your-turn timer. If nothing is live, Force Blue is not on screen.
- **Tertiary colors are status only.** They mark a level on the shared 1–5 ramp (report scores Excellent to Needs work, mastery Mastered to Starting out; level 3 uses Light Blue), a completed step, an error, or AI content. Always pair color with a word so meaning survives without color.
- **Muted text is Dark Blue at 68% opacity.** The brand palette has no mid-tone text gray, and #999999 fails contrast on white.
- **No gradients or glows.** The one exception is the area fading under the Moments line. The old orange-pink-violet avatar gradient is retired, and the stage is flat Dark Blue.

Accessible pairings

PAIRING	CONTRAST	USE
CWRU Blue on white	12.6:1	Titles, primary text links on light
White on CWRU Blue	12.6:1	Sidebar, primary buttons
True Blue on white	4.7:1	Links, active tab label
White on Blue Green	4.8:1	Done-step icon
White on Copper Red	4.6:1	End session, destructive buttons
Dark Blue on Orange	8.0:1	Level 2 chip (never white text)
Dark Blue on Vivid Green	5.9:1	Level 5 chip (never white text)
Dark Gray on white	2.8:1	Fails. Disabled controls only.

Replace these values in the codebase

TODAY	WHERE	BECOMES
#003087	`tailwind.config.mjs` weatherhead.primary	CWRU Blue `#003071`
#102331	Practice pickers	Dark Blue `#09143A`
#0a7391	Practice pickers	True Blue (actions) or Blue Green (status)
#082b4c, #142c3f	`styles/globals.css` report navy, ink	Dark Blue
#0066a6	`styles/globals.css` report blue	True Blue `#007AB8`
#a97928	`styles/globals.css` report gold	Orange, with Dark Blue text
avatar-gradient	`tailwind.config.mjs`	Retire; use the stage texture

Color tokens (CSS)

```
:root {
  /* brand */
  --la-cwru-blue:  #003071;
  --la-dark-blue:  #09143A;
  --la-true-blue:  #007AB8;
  --la-force-blue: #2359EF;
  --la-light-blue: #A6D2E6;
  /* neutrals */
  --la-surface: #FFFFFF;
  --la-canvas:  #F5F8FB;
  --la-line:    rgb(9 20 58 / 0.14);
  --la-muted:   rgb(9 20 58 / 0.68);
  --la-disabled:#999999;
  /* status (tertiary) */
  --la-mastered:   #61A530;
  --la-proficient: #377E72;
  --la-developing: #FF9239;
  --la-needs-work: #D63D1F;
  --la-ai:         #692C95;
}
```

03

Typography

A serif for moments, a sans for work, a mono for time.

Aa	Aa	Aa
Newsreader	**Public Sans**	**IBM Plex Mono**
Titles, headings, figures, statements	Everything you read and operate	Timestamps and time ranges

`Title · 32/1.1 Newsreader 500`	Your interview report
`Figure · 40/1.0 Newsreader 500`	4 / 5 138 wpm
`Section · 22–26 Newsreader 500`	Strengths
`Statement · 24/1.35 Newsreader italic`	*End each story with the result as a number.*
`Body · 15–17/1.55 Public Sans 400`	You named the stakes early. Next time, quantify the result.
`Label · 13/1.3 Public Sans 600`	**Speech rate**
`Small · 12.5–13 Public Sans 400`	Inside the interview target of 100–159 wpm
`Time · 13/1.5 Plex Mono 400`	`4:05–4:22`

Type rules

- **Newsreader has four roles:** the page title, section headings, score and stat figures, and statements (the practice-next line, evidence and transcript quotes, in italic). Never on buttons, tabs, labels, chips, tables or forms.
- **Italic is for whole statements,** never one accent word inside a heading.
- **Sentence case everywhere,** labels included. No tracked uppercase, no mono labels, no decorative index numbers, no label above a page title.
- **Mono is for time only:** timestamps and time ranges.
- **Sizes for app screens:** titles 32px, figures 36–40px, nothing at 48px or more. Running text max 65ch; statements about 48ch.
- **Tabular figures** in tables, stat figures and timers.
- **Kiosk mode** scales the whole set by 1.25 (body becomes ~19px) rather than introducing new sizes.

Loading the fonts in Next.js

Use `next/font/google` in the root layout so fonts self-host and don't shift layout. Expose them as CSS variables and map them in `tailwind.config.mjs` under `fontFamily.display`, `sans`, and `mono`.

```
import { Newsreader, Public_Sans, IBM_Plex_Mono } from "next/font/google";

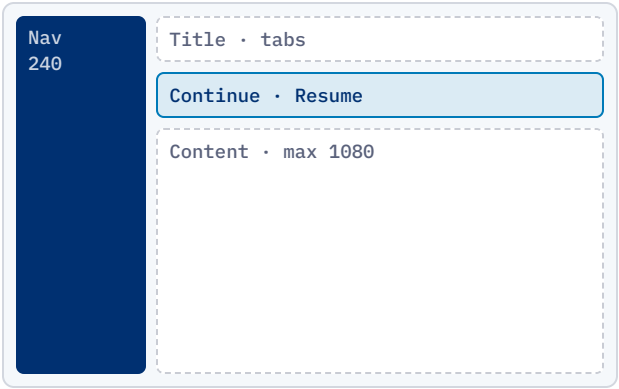
const display = Newsreader({ subsets: ["latin"], weight: ["400", "500"], style:
["normal", "italic"], variable: "--font-display" });
const sans = Public_Sans({ subsets: ["latin"], weight: ["400", "600", "700"],
variable: "--font-sans" });
const mono = IBM_Plex_Mono({ subsets: ["latin"], weight: ["400", "500"],
variable: "--font-mono" });
```

04

Layout

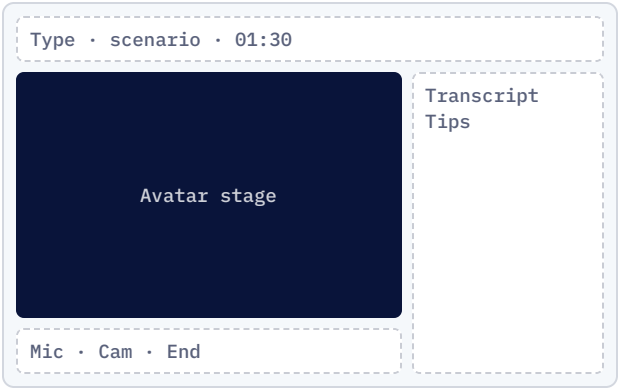
Three frames cover every student screen.

App shell



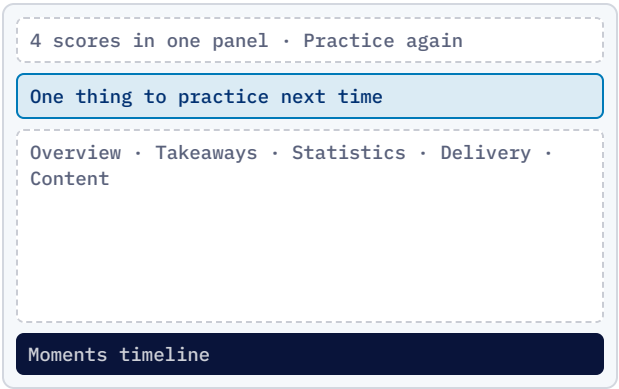
Home, Reports, Study Plans, Paths, Mastery, Settings.

Session



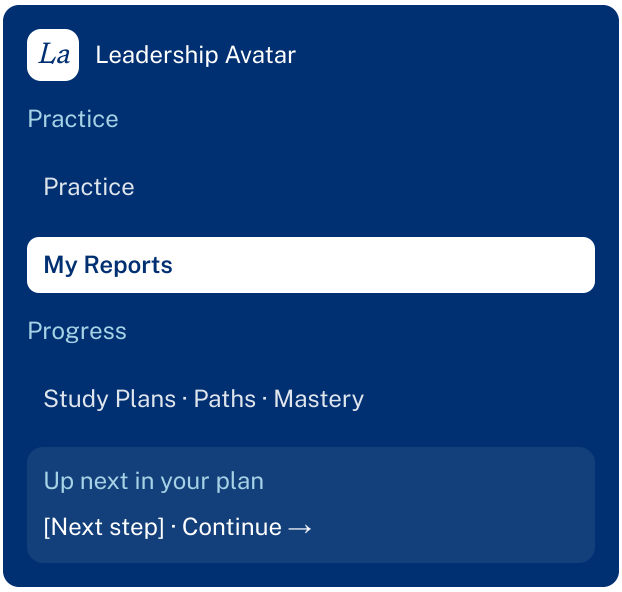
Nav collapses. Stage 2/3, panel 1/3.

Report



Scores first, tabs for detail, the timeline closes the page.

Sidebar



Flat CWRU Blue. Character from the mark, the Up next card, the logo plate and the profile row.



4px base · use only these steps

4 8 12 16 24 32 48 64

Grid, widths, and breakpoints

SPEC	VALUE	NOTES
Sidebar	256px · 72px collapsed	Collapsed on session screens and below 1024px
Content width	max 1080px	Reading blocks max 65ch inside it
Grid	12 columns · 24px gutter	16px gutter below 768px
Page padding	32px · 16px mobile	Top of page to title: 32px
Section gap	32px	Between related groups: 16px; inside a card: 12px
Breakpoints	640 · 768 · 1024 · 1280	Session side panel moves under the stage below 1024
Desktop frame	1440×900 first	At 900px and wider the sidebar stays fixed and only the content scrolls; narrower, it stacks on top
Kiosk	1920×1080, no sidebar	Type scaled 1.25×; touch targets 56px
Touch target	44px minimum	Matches existing `spacing.touch`

Layout rules

- **Left-aligned.** Center content only on empty states and the kiosk attract screen.
- **One primary action per view,** placed bottom-right of its card or at the end of the page flow.
- **Summary above detail.** The first 600px of any page answer "where am I and what do I do next."
- **Use gap, not margins,** for spacing between siblings, with values from the 4px scale.
- **Cards hold one object** (a session, a step, a report). Don't nest cards inside cards.

05

Textures and surfaces

Five surfaces, flat by default. Depth only where something floats.

Canvas
Page background

Surface
Cards · 1px line, no shadow

Raised
Menus, dialogs, drawers



Stage
Avatar video, Moments timeline



Dot grid
Login and kiosk only



Hatch
Not started · no data yet

Radius, borders, shadow, motion

PROPERTY	VALUE	WHERE
Radius 4	4px	Inputs, small tags
Radius 8	8px	Cards, buttons, disclosures
Radius 12	12px	Dialogs, avatar stage
Pill	999px	Status chips, progress tracks
Border	1px Dark Blue @ 14%	All cards and dividers
Shadow	`0 12px 32px rgb(9 20 58 / .16)`	Raised surfaces only
Motion	150ms ease-out hover · 200ms expand	Off under reduced motion

Textures are CSS, never images: the dot grid is a 1px Light Blue radial gradient at 35% on a 12px tile; the hatch is a 135° stripe of Dark Blue at 6%. Neither sits behind body text.

06

UI treatments

The components every screen is built from.

BUTTONS

Start practice | View report | Skip

End session

LEVEL CHIPS · 1 TO 5

Excellent · Strong · Solid · Developing · Needs work

SIGNALS

Avatar speaking · AI feedback

SELECTABLE CARDS

Interview
Behavioral and case

Pitch
Investor or internal

PROGRESS

Study plan · 5 of 8 steps

✓ ✓ 3 4 5

Report scores are never one ring or one number: see the score panel.

TABS AND INPUT

In progress | Completed

Target role

Product manager

SCORE PANEL

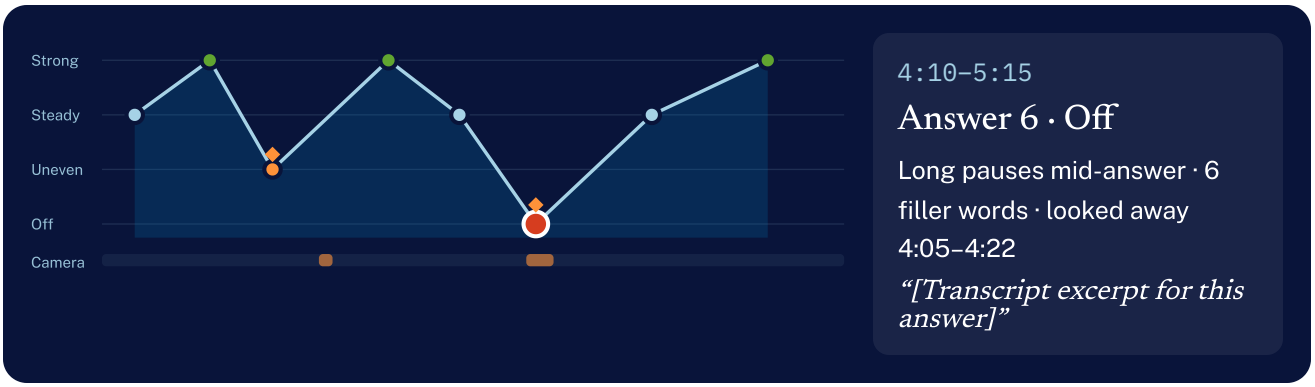
Visual	Vocal	Content and structure	Behavioral and mindset
4 / 5	3 / 5	2 / 5	4 / 5
Strong	Solid	Developing	Strong

STAT TILES · STATISTICS TAB

Speech rate	Filler words	On camera	Speaking time
138 wpm	19 total	94 %	6:32 of 7:30
Inside the interview target of 100–159 wpm	2.9 per minute, mostly in answers 3 and 6	Face visible for most of the session	87% of the session

Example figures. Eight tiles in the real tab: speech rate, filler words, pauses, volume consistency, on camera, eye contact, framing, speaking time.

MOMENTS TIMELINE



Each point is a button. Selecting one fills the panel; the weakest point pulses. Needs a per-answer delivery level and matched transcript excerpts before it ships.

EXPANDABLE AND EXTRACTABLE SECTION

> Full transcript — 18 turns · 6 min read

Expand Open in panel Copy Download .txt

Component rules

- **Buttons:** 40px tall (44px touch), 8px radius, 600 weight, verb-first labels ("Start practice", not "Practice"). One primary per view. Copper Red only for ending or deleting.
- **Level chips:** tinted fill at 16% (Light Blue at 32% for level 3), solid dot, Dark Blue text. Always show the word; the color is a second signal. Labels come from the code (report score labels, mastery level names), never retyped.
- **AI label:** any text a model wrote on the fly (coach tips, summaries, study-plan rationale) carries the Violet "AI feedback" tag, in sentence case.
- **Live signal:** Force Blue dot with a soft halo, plus a text label. Shown only while something is actually live.
- **Selectable cards:** resting 1px line; selected 2px True Blue border on Light Blue tint. Single-select pickers keep the Continue button disabled until a choice is made.
- **Progress:** bars for a plan's overall progress, step dots for sequence. Report scores sit in one panel split by dividers, four figures out of 5, never a combined ring. Done steps use Blue Green, the current step CWRU Blue.
- **Peer figures share one panel** split by dividers: no rows of separate cards, no icons in tinted squares.
- **Motion** is feedback or points at something: hover 150ms, the timeline line drawing once, one pulse on the weakest answer, a target ripple that plays twice. No staggered entrances or decorative loops; all of it stops under reduced motion.
- **Inputs:** label above, 4px radius, True Blue focus ring at 3px. Error text in Copper Red under the field, stating how to fix it.
- **Icons:** Lucide (already installed), 20px, 1.5px stroke, inheriting text color. Icons sit beside a label; icon-only buttons need an `aria-label`.

07

Show less, reveal more

Text budget per view, and where the rest goes.

8	2	3	1
words max in a page title	sentences max in any visible summary	key points shown before "Show all"	primary action per view

Level 1 · always visible	Level 2 · one click	Level 3 · extract
Glance	**Expand**	**Panel or file**
Title, status, score, next action.	Reasons, rubric, examples, tips.	Transcripts, full feedback, exports.

Where each kind of content goes

CONTENT	LEVEL	TREATMENT
Four category scores with level words	1	Score panel
"One thing to practice next time"	1	Tinted panel under the scores
Strength and growth-area titles	1	Collapsed rows, 3 visible
Detail, evidence quotes, suggestions	2	Inside each row
Learning points	1	Takeaways tab: Keep doing, Work on next, Rewatch
Headline delivery and camera figures	1	Statistics tab, one line under each figure
How each answer went over time	1 → 2	Moments timeline; selecting a point opens its detail
Full session transcript	3	Side panel, with Copy and Download
Study-plan rationale	2	Disclosure under each step
Case background reading	3	Side panel during setup; summary stays visible
Scenario instructions before a session	1 → 2	3 bullets visible, "Full brief" expands
Consent and recording details	1 → 2	One sentence visible, policy expands; consent stays explicit

How to build expandable and extractable sections

- **Expandable:** use a disclosure (HeroUI Accordion or native `<details>`). The summary line names the content and its size, for example "Full transcript · 18 turns". Closed by default.
- **Extractable:** long content offers "Open in panel" (a right-side drawer, 480px, that keeps the page visible) plus Copy and Download where it helps the student keep it.
- **Remember state** per user for the session, so a reopened report keeps the sections they had open.
- **Print and PDF exports expand everything.** Hidden on screen never means missing from a saved report.
- **Never hide what blocks a decision.** Errors, required consent, deadlines, and the primary action are always level 1.

Voice and microcopy

- Address the student as "you". Coaching is first person from the coach ("I noticed…"), matching the existing study-plan voice.
- Name things by what students recognize: "Practice", "My Reports", "Study Plans". Not engine or route names.
- No marketing copy, eyebrows, or testimonials inside the app.
- Errors say what happened and what to do: "Camera blocked. Allow camera in your browser settings, then retry."
- Never invent outcomes, stats, or quotes.

08

Apply it consistently

Check every new or changed screen against this list.

- ✓ Uses the app shell or session frame
- ✓ Colors come from tokens, no raw hex
- ✓ One primary action, in CWRU Blue
- ✓ Type sizes from the scale only
- ✓ Within the text budget; extra text expands
- ✓ Status shown with word plus color
- ✓ Keyboard reachable with visible focus
- ✓ Text passes 4.5:1 on its background
- ✓ No uppercase labels, accent words, icon tiles or glows
- ✓ Motion points at something and stops under reduced motion

Surface by surface

SURFACE	FRAME	UP FRONT	BEHIND A CLICK
Home	Shell	Continue card, next step	Recent reports list
Practice picker	Shell	Question heading, type cards, Continue	Type descriptions, scenario briefs
Device check	Shell, centered card	Preview, device selects, consent line, Start	Recording policy, troubleshooting
Live session	Session	Avatar, timer, turn count, End	Transcript and tips panel (collapsible)
Report	Report	Score panel, practice-next line, Practice again	Takeaways, Statistics, Delivery and Content tabs; the Moments timeline detail
Study plans, Paths, Mastery	Shell	Progress bar, current step, Start step	Step rationale, completed history

Rollout order

- **Tokens first.** Add the color, type, radius, and spacing tokens to `styles/globals.css` and `tailwind.config.mjs`, and map HeroUI's primary to CWRU Blue so admin screens shift without edits.
- **Shell second.** Restyle the sidebar and page header once; every student page inherits it.
- **Report and session third.** These carry the most custom color (report gold, avatar gradient) and the most text to put behind disclosures.
- **Pickers and paths last,** replacing the teal and navy one-offs.

Color values from CWRU Visual Identity · Color. For logo use and print, follow the full CWRU Brand Guidelines; questions go to the CWRU brand team.

Contrast ratios computed for WCAG 2.1 AA. Leadership Avatar Brand Guidelines v1.0.